

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed The Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Obama's VP Is A Tech Hater

Obama has gone ahead and picked a vice presidential candidate who is known to be harsh on file sharing networks and Internet privacy. When Joe Biden was a senator, he sponsored a bill that would make using any software that plays MP3 files on a computer a criminal offence. Thankfully, the bill was not passed because all the heavyweights of Silicon Valley were against it, and for once Apple and Microsoft were on the same side. He has also sponsored another bill backed by the

RIAA (Recording Industry Association of America) that makes it difficult for listeners to record songs from satellite and Internet radio stations.

If all the tech-hate was not enough, Biden does not want the common public to have access to e-mail encryption, as one of his many counter-terrorism measures. The measures include allowing government access to all kinds of information transmitted by voice, text, data or any other form of communication.



Mac Addict For Microsoft

Usually it is Bill Gates who has to eat his words with infamous proclamations like "Spam will be a thing of the past in two years' time."

This time around, it's the guys at Apple who are left in the lurch. Jerry Seinfeld has just been hired by Microsoft to be a part of a \$300 million advertising campaign. This after the latest offerings by Mac were seen in the background of many Seinfeld episodes, and a decade after Mac proclaimed "Jerry would never use a PC" in one of their own advertising campaigns. For a writer and a comedian, working in the entertainment industry, there must be a pretty good reason to switch loyalties from a Mac to a PC. The reason happens to be \$10 million worth of greenbacks, which is sufficient incentive to make anyone change his mind.



Beat It

Wacko Jacko turned 50 on August 29. To celebrate the occasion, Sony BMG, GMTV and the Sun released a compilation of his greatest hits in an album called the *King of Pop*. The album itself is unique as fans get to vote for their favourite songs and each country the album is released in will have a different tracklist based on the votes of that country. To promote the album, Jackson released a game across three social networking sites to allow fans (those that still exist anyway) to make a virtual version of Jackson dance. While it is not clear whether there is any combination of keys that can make the digital Jackson grab his crotch, there are a bunch of hourly and daily prizes up for grabs. Every hour, the best player gets a ringtone, and the best player for every day gets a limited edition *King of Pop* iPod Nano. The top 5 players (over 18) have a chance at grabbing two round-the-world plane tickets, or a Sony Bravia 32-inch TV. For the under-18 category, the top prize is a PS3 and thankfully not a trip to Neverland Ranch.